

Python Adventure Game - Project Report

Course End Project: Building a Python Adventure Game with GitHub Copilot

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Project file: `adventure_game.py`

Tool used: VS Code with the GitHub Copilot extension

Overview

For this project I built a text based adventure game in Python called "The Quest for the Legendary Treasure". The player is an explorer who is looking for a treasure. The game asks for the player's name and then gives them choices to explore a dark forest or a mysterious cave. Each choice leads to another choice and the game ends in one of three ways: you win by finding the treasure, you lose by making a bad choice, or you can restart and play again.

I split the game into functions like the project asked. `start_game()` shows the intro and the first choice, `forest_path()` and `cave_path()` handle the two main areas, and `treasure_room()` is the ending part. I also made a small helper called `get_choice()` so I didn't have to write the same input checking code over and over.

How GitHub Copilot Helped

GitHub Copilot helped me a lot while I was writing the code. Here are the main ways it helped:

- After I wrote a function name and a comment, Copilot would suggest the rest of the function, like the print statements and the input lines. This saved me a lot of typing.
- It was really good at writing the if/else parts. Once I did the first choice, it could guess the pattern for the next choices and suggest similar code.
- When I had the same input checking code copied in a few places, Copilot helped me turn it into the `get_choice()` function so the code was cleaner.
- It also helped me come up with some of the story text for the forest and the cave so I didn't have to think of every sentence myself.

Challenges I Faced

- The hardest part was planning out all the different paths and making sure every choice actually leads to an ending and not a dead end. I had to draw it out on paper first before coding it.
- At first the game crashed if the player typed something that wasn't an option. I fixed this with the `get_choice()` function that keeps asking until you type a valid answer.
- Sometimes Copilot suggested code that looked right but didn't actually fit my game, like using a variable I hadn't made yet. So I had to read the suggestions carefully and test them instead of just accepting everything.

Things I Added or Changed

- I added more than one choice per path so each path has a few decisions instead of just one.
- I used a key (a True/False value) that you can pick up. The `treasure_room()` function checks if you have the key to decide what options you get at the end.
- I made both paths end in the same `treasure_room()` function so I didn't repeat the ending code twice.
- I added the `get_choice()` helper so the game doesn't crash on bad input.
- I put the whole game inside a while loop in `main()` so the player can keep playing again until they type n.

Conclusion

This project helped me practice Python functions, conditionals, loops and lists by making something fun. GitHub Copilot made it faster to write the code because it handled a lot of the repeated parts and gave me suggestions, but I still had to design the game, fix the bugs, and check that everything worked. Overall I'm happy with how the game turned out and it would be easy to add more locations later.